which he later won the Oscar for best actor). He asked if he could call me “Kip”; I said of course and asked what I should call him. “Anything but Matt; I hate Matt.” “Matthew.” “McConaughey.” “Hey you.” “Whatever you like.” I chose “McConaughey” as it trips off the tongue so nicely, and there are too many Matthews in my life.

McConaughey had removed all the furniture from the suite’s huge living/dining room, except an L-shaped couch and a coffee table. Strewn over the floor and table were 12-by-18-inch sheets of paper, each covered with notes dealing with a particular topic, written in random directions, squiwampus. We sat on the couch. He would pick up a sheet, browse it, and ask a question. The question was usually deep, and triggered a long discussion during which he would write notes on the sheet.

Often the discussion would take off in unexpected directions, with the sheet forgotten. It was one of the most interesting and enjoyable conversations I’ve had in a long time! We wandered from the laws of physics, especially quantum physics, to religion and mysticism, to the science of *Interstellar*, to our families and especially our children, to our philosophies of life, to how we each get inspirations, how our minds work, how we make discoveries. I left, two hours later, in a state of euphoria.

Later I told Lynda about our meeting. “Of course,” she responded. She could have told me what to expect; *Interstellar* is her third film with McConaughey. I’m glad she didn’t tell me. It was a joy to discover for myself.

The next e-mail, a few weeks later, was from Anne Hathaway, who plays Amelia Brand. “Hi Kip! I hope this e-mail finds you well. . . . Emma Thomas passed along your e-mail in case I had any questions. Well, the subject matter is pretty dense so I have a few! . . . would we be able to chat? Thank you very much, Annie.”